

JOY COMES IN THE MORNING

A Scripture-Based CBT Workbook
for Depression

Psalm 30:5 - Weeping may stay for the night,
but joy comes in the morning.

By Daniel Tesfamariam

JOY COMES IN THE MORNING

By Daniel Tesfamariam

Copyright 2025. All rights reserved.

This workbook does not replace professional treatment.

If you are in crisis: 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline

Published by KIDLYTICAL Books

UNDERSTANDING DEPRESSION

Faith + Science

Depression is more than sadness. It's a medical condition that affects:

- Your mood (persistent sadness, emptiness, hopelessness)
- Your body (fatigue, sleep changes, appetite changes)
- Your thinking (concentration, decision-making, self-worth)
- Your spirit (feeling distant from God, loss of meaning)

Biblical figures who likely experienced depression:

- Elijah: 'I've had enough, LORD. Take my life.' (1 Kings 19:4)
- David: 'How long will you forget me?' (Psalm 13:1)
- Jeremiah: 'Why did I come from the womb?' (Jeremiah 20:18)
- Jonah: 'It is better for me to die.' (Jonah 4:3)

God did not condemn them. He MET them where they were.

He sent an angel with food to Elijah (1 Kings 19:5-7).

He invited honest lament from David (the Psalms).

IS DEPRESSION A FAITH PROBLEM?

NO.

Depression is not:

- A sign of weak faith
- God's punishment
- Something you can 'pray away' (though prayer helps)
- Your fault

Depression IS:

- A real medical condition (brain chemistry matters)
- Something faithful people experience
- Treatable with therapy, medication, and support
- Something God cares deeply about (Psalm 34:18)

Getting help is WISE, not weak (Proverbs 12:15).

Taking medication is not lack of faith -

just as a diabetic takes insulin, you may need support.

'The LORD is close to the brokenhearted and saves those who are crushed in spirit.' - Psalm 34:18

BEHAVIORAL ACTIVATION WITH SCRIPTURE

Doing brings feeling (not the other way around)

When depressed, we WAIT to feel better before doing things.

CBT teaches: DO the thing, and feelings often follow.

James 1:22 - 'Be doers of the word, not hearers only.'

Small steps count! Rate each activity (0-10) for:

M = Mastery (sense of accomplishment)

P = Pleasure (even small enjoyment)

MY ACTIVATION LIST:

- ☐ Walk outside (even 5 min)
- ☐ Text a friend
- ☐ Read 1 Psalm
- ☐ Shower/get dressed
- ☐ Listen to worship music
- ☐ Cook a simple meal
- ☐ Call someone
- ☐ Attend church
- ☐ Journal 3 sentences

ACTIVITY SCHEDULE WITH GOD

Plan your week. Include spiritual disciplines. Rate M/P after.

Time	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Morning							
Midday							
Afternoon							
Evening							

Spiritual disciplines to include: Prayer, Scripture, Worship, Fellowship

THOUGHT RECORD: HOPELESSNESS #1

Situation:

Hopeless thought:

Evidence this is TRUE:

Evidence this is NOT completely true:

What would I tell a friend?:

What does God say? (Scripture):

More balanced thought:

Hopelessness before (0-100): ____ After: ____

THOUGHT RECORD: HOPELESSNESS #2

Situation:

Hopeless thought:

Evidence this is TRUE:

Evidence this is NOT completely true:

What would I tell a friend?:

What does God say? (Scripture):

More balanced thought:

Hopelessness before (0-100): ____ After: ____

THOUGHT RECORD: HOPELESSNESS #3

Situation:

Hopeless thought:

Evidence this is TRUE:

Evidence this is NOT completely true:

What would I tell a friend?:

What does God say? (Scripture):

More balanced thought:

Hopelessness before (0-100): ____ After: ____

THOUGHT RECORD: HOPELESSNESS #4

Situation:

Hopeless thought:

Evidence this is TRUE:

Evidence this is NOT completely true:

What would I tell a friend?:

What does God say? (Scripture):

More balanced thought:

Hopelessness before (0-100): ____ After: ____

THOUGHT RECORD: HOPELESSNESS #5

Situation:

Hopeless thought:

Evidence this is TRUE:

Evidence this is NOT completely true:

What would I tell a friend?:

What does God say? (Scripture):

More balanced thought:

Hopelessness before (0-100): ____ After: ____

PSALMS OF LAMENT

It's okay to grieve before God

Over 1/3 of the Psalms are laments - cries of pain to God.

God INVITES our honest grief. He is not threatened by our pain.

Lament Psalms to read when you're struggling:

Psalm 13 - How long, O LORD?

Psalm 22 - My God, why have you forsaken me?

Psalm 42 - Why so downcast, O my soul?

Psalm 88 - The darkest Psalm (no resolution - and that's okay)

Psalm 130 - Out of the depths I cry to you

Pattern of lament: Cry out -> Trust -> Ask -> Praise

You can start at 'cry out' and stay there. God hears.

WRITE YOUR OWN LAMENT:

God, I feel...

MY VALUES - WHAT MATTERS TO GOD AND ME

Depression makes us forget what matters. Let's remember.

- Faith/Spiritual Growth:	Importance (1-10): ____	Current effort (1-10): ____
- Family:	Importance (1-10): ____	Current effort (1-10): ____
- Friendships:	Importance (1-10): ____	Current effort (1-10): ____
- Health:	Importance (1-10): ____	Current effort (1-10): ____
- Education/Learning:	Importance (1-10): ____	Current effort (1-10): ____
- Creativity:	Importance (1-10): ____	Current effort (1-10): ____
- Service to Others:	Importance (1-10): ____	Current effort (1-10): ____
- Work/Career:	Importance (1-10): ____	Current effort (1-10): ____
- Nature/Outdoors:	Importance (1-10): ____	Current effort (1-10): ____
- Community/Church:	Importance (1-10): ____	Current effort (1-10): ____

Where is the biggest gap? That's where to start.

WEEKLY TRACKER - WEEK 1

Day	Mood	Activity	M/P	Faith Practice	Sleep
Mon					
Tue					
Wed					
Thu					
Fri					
Sat					
Sun					

Best moment this week:

Something I'm grateful for:

WEEKLY TRACKER - WEEK 2

Day	Mood	Activity	M/P	Faith Practice	Sleep
Mon					
Tue					
Wed					
Thu					
Fri					
Sat					
Sun					

Best moment this week:

Something I'm grateful for:

WEEKLY TRACKER - WEEK 3

Day	Mood	Activity	M/P	Faith Practice	Sleep
Mon					
Tue					
Wed					
Thu					
Fri					
Sat					
Sun					

Best moment this week:

Something I'm grateful for:

WEEKLY TRACKER - WEEK 4

Day	Mood	Activity	M/P	Faith Practice	Sleep
Mon					
Tue					
Wed					
Thu					
Fri					
Sat					
Sun					

Best moment this week:

Something I'm grateful for:

WEEKLY TRACKER - WEEK 5

Day	Mood	Activity	M/P	Faith Practice	Sleep
Mon					
Tue					
Wed					
Thu					
Fri					
Sat					
Sun					

Best moment this week:

Something I'm grateful for:

WEEKLY TRACKER - WEEK 6

Day	Mood	Activity	M/P	Faith Practice	Sleep
Mon					
Tue					
Wed					
Thu					
Fri					
Sat					
Sun					

Best moment this week:

Something I'm grateful for:

WEEKLY TRACKER - WEEK 7

Day	Mood	Activity	M/P	Faith Practice	Sleep
Mon					
Tue					
Wed					
Thu					
Fri					
Sat					
Sun					

Best moment this week:

Something I'm grateful for:

WEEKLY TRACKER - WEEK 8

Day	Mood	Activity	M/P	Faith Practice	Sleep
Mon					
Tue					
Wed					
Thu					
Fri					
Sat					
Sun					

Best moment this week:

Something I'm grateful for:

RELAPSE WARNING SIGNS

Know your early warning signs so you can act quickly:

- ☐ Withdrawing from people
- ☐ Sleeping too much or too little
- ☐ Skipping meals
- ☐ Negative self-talk increasing
- ☐ Avoiding church/community
- ☐ Losing interest in activities
- ☐ Feeling worthless
- ☐ Difficulty concentrating

MY personal warning signs:

When I notice these, I will:

BUILDING MY SUPPORT TEAM

You were not meant to do this alone. (Ecclesiastes 4:9-10)

Professional (therapist/counselor):

Name: _____ Phone: _____

Pastor/Church leader:

Name: _____ Phone: _____

Trusted friend:

Name: _____ Phone: _____

Family member:

Name: _____ Phone: _____

Small group/Bible study:

Meeting time: _____

Doctor:

Name: _____ Phone: _____

WHEN TO SEEK PROFESSIONAL HELP

Seek help immediately if you:

- Have thoughts of hurting yourself
- Have a plan to end your life
- Feel hopeless for more than 2 weeks straight
- Cannot function (work, eat, sleep, care for family)

CALL 988 if you are in crisis.

Seek help soon if:

- Depression lasts more than 2 weeks
- Your daily life is significantly affected
- You are self-medicating with alcohol or substances
- Prayer and community are not enough

Remember: Seeking help is STRENGTH, not weakness.

Jesus said the sick need a doctor (Mark 2:17).

God uses therapists, doctors, and community to heal.